

RUTH TADESSE

Burke, VA | ruthad48@gmail.com | rutad2.github.io/portfolio

UX / Product Design student at George Mason (double major in Computational Data Science), graduating December 2026. Two end-to-end case studies below — one a course project, one self-directed — each taken from user research through a working Figma prototype.

EDUCATION

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

B.A. Art and Visual Technologies

Additional Major: B.S. Computational Data Science

Expected Graduation: December 2026

Relevant Coursework: User Experience Design, Mobile App Design (in progress), Web Design, Typography, Graphic Design Methods & Principles

SKILLS

UX & Product Design: User Research, Usability Testing, Wireframing, Prototyping, User Flows, Personas, Competitive Analysis, Information Architecture, Interaction Design

Design Tools: Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe InDesign, Miro

Technical: HTML, CSS, Python, Git

Languages: Fluent in English and Amharic

UX / PRODUCT DESIGN PROJECTS

Curlè — Personalized Curly Hair Care App | UX Research & Product Design

Class Project · Spring 2025, 15-week semester · Figma, Miro, Google Forms

- Surveyed 27 people with curly or textured hair and interviewed a subset of them to find out why building a hair care routine feels like guesswork
- Built 2 personas and a sitemap from the research; 73% of respondents wanted an app that combined hair analysis with routine guidance, which became the core “AI hair scan” feature
- Compared 4 competitor apps, then designed the full flow in Figma — onboarding, the hair scan, a routine dashboard, and a product match-score screen — starting from paper sketches and low-fidelity wireframes
- Built a clickable prototype in Figma and outlined next-step usability testing to check the scan's accuracy across different hair textures

ParkPlan — National Park Trip Planning App | UX Research & Product Design

Personal Project · 2-month self-directed · Figma, Google Forms

- Surveyed 18 travelers and interviewed 5 more about how they actually plan national park trips — most said they bounce between 3+ websites to piece one trip together
- Compared the concept against AllTrails, the National Park Service site, and Google Maps; none let you plan a full trip in one place, so that gap became the design focus
- Sorted possible features by value vs. effort to scope an MVP, then organized the app around the trip itself — explore, plan, save, manage — instead of by topic
- Took the design from wireframes to a high-fidelity Figma UI and a clickable prototype covering search through a saved itinerary

ADDITIONAL DESIGN WORK

- DC Travel Guide & Graphic Design Course Website — two coursework websites focused on typography, layout, and visual hierarchy